



Tabletop

By Satvik 'SA1NT' Pandey | feedback@skoar.in



5 ALIVE

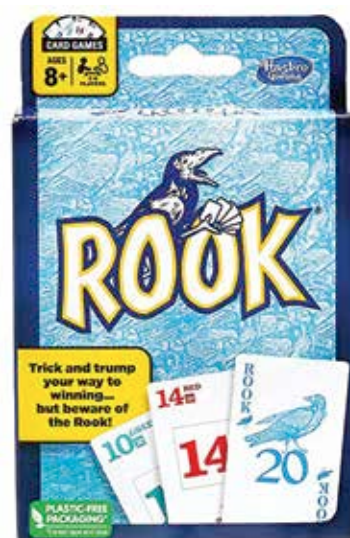
Ever heard of that card game where you throw reverse cards? Well, take that and add some life cards to it, which get deducted over the game, controlling the outcome, and you get 5 Alive. The game in itself is super fun and easy to play with rules that are intuitive for anyone who has been playing card games even for a short time. However, we cannot look past the fact that the game's concept is inspired by another card game, which is undoubtedly more popular than this one. The fact that the game's creators are the same is very clearly reflected in how it plays and is structured.

Credit where credit's due, you will have fun playing it. If you have a

group of friends over at your place, this game will perfectly bind the room together with laughs and fun. With fewer players, it mostly boils down to pure luck and most of the fun is sucked out of it. Similarly, when left with fewer players in a bigger group, it is better to choose an alternate way to end the game to avoid being stuck with the same ending every single time. If there were a few tweaks made to the overall gameplay to sneak in a unique playing experience, and some more was thought put into making the imagery on the cards a bit more attractive to the younger audiences, it would have been rated much higher than it is. Pick it up if you want a simple game to play at parties *wink*. If you're looking for unique and interesting gameplay, look elsewhere.

ROOK

It would take a little less than a PhD. in rocket science to understand the rules of Rook. This thought echoed in the room when we sat down to play this game. We have seen people swear by the game, touting it to be one of the best games in the market to play with family and friends. But as per our experience with the game, most of it was consumed in understanding how to play it. Once we got through the two-page rulebook a few times and were able to understand the loop of regulations that the game



runs on, things start to pick up.

After getting the hang of the rules we did enjoy the game. It was intriguing and hooked us for hours and hours on end. The variation in the rules proved to be a great point for us to work around and make the game even more interesting. No two games ended the same. Picking a partner was the toughest part of all though.

Rook is a classic. Once our SKOAR overlord walked in, he took over the space with his tactics and game sense that went over what everyone else collectively had. Turns out, he had played the game before. We guess having someone around who has played the game before definitely helps to fasttrack the learning process, which can take absurdly long. *